



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

Minutes of the Meeting
Wednesday, March 9, 2026, 7:00 PM
at the Town Hall, 1 South Road

CALL TO ORDER

The Selectboard was called to order at 7:02 PM

PRESENT: Susan Bronstein (Chair), Jennifer Milikowsky (by Zoom)

NOT PRESENT: Scott Johndrow

ALSO PRESENT: Douglas Finn, Others as noted.

PUBLIC COMMENT on any item not on the agenda

No public comment given.

CHANGE TO GROUP HEALTH INSURANCE – Discussion and Vote

In accordance with 801 CMR 52.02(1), the Selectboard will deliberate and vote on whether to begin the process to change health insurance benefits under G.L. c. 32B, §§21-23.

Mr Finn reviewed the current status of Group Health Insurance and the HCGIT, noting that the first step is to adopt the use of M.G.L c. 32B, Sections 21-23, in order to allow the Town to implement the changes to change health insurance benefits under the terms of that section.

Ms. Milikowsky noted that the proposed plan changes were imposed on the town by the trust, not the town. Mr. Finn noted that all parties identified in the statute had received due notice of the impending vote.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Bronstein

To begin the process of making changes to the Town's group health insurance plan in accordance with MGL Chapter 32B, Sections 21-23.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (7:05 PM)

AMBULANCE SERVICES CONTRACT – City of Easthampton

The Selectboard will review a Memorandum of Understanding for ambulance services for the Town of Westhampton for the Fy27 – Fy29 fiscal years. Votes may be taken.

PRESENT: Fire Chief Dave Antosz.

The board reviewed the proposed contract, and Chief Antosz spoke about the terms of the contract.

Chief Antosz described the contract as a general renewal, but with increases to the annual term. \$60,000 per year, with increases of \$5,000 per year for the term of the contract. Chief Antosz noted the fees paid by some other similar sized towns near Westhampton, noting that the cost of

Westhampton in terms of service for the price was a great benefit to the Town. General Agreement by the Board.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Bronstein

To approve the three-year contract as presented, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:09 PM)

Chief Antosz provided the board with statistics for run calls for the year from January 1, 2026: 252 calls, including police, fire and medical calls, and presented a summary of the types of calls.. Chief Antosz noted that inspections are not included in the statistics as presented.

MUNICIPAL WEBSITE - Use Policy

Board will review proposed policy changes for content on municipal website.

Mr. Finn noted that proposed additions to the public space use policy had been drawn up, but not yet distributed to members. He asked that board members take time to review the changes and that the matter be discussed at the next regular meeting. Agreed by consensus.

ADMINISTRATIVE

Approval of bulk mailing to town residents promoting date / time of budget information presentations and the special town election

Mr. Finn presented a draft of a postcard to be sent to all town residents, and discussed details. No objection to the Board.

PRESENTATION – Smart Meters

The board will receive a brief presentation from Sue O'Rourke and Kate O'Connor about their concerns about Smart Meters.

Present: Ms. Sue O'Rourke and Ms. Kate O'Connor.

Also present via Zoom: Mr. Jonathan Mirin, Hilltown Health.

Ms. O'Connor and Ms. O'Rourke gave a presentation in regard to wireless services and devices that use wireless services, such as smart meters, wifi and cellular communication antennae. The two outlined their concerns, including their assertions about the risks and hazards of wirelessly-connected residential electric meters on human health.

Ms. O'Rourke detailed some of her past, and her concerns about various sources of electromagnetic fields ("EMFs").

Ms. O'Connor spoke about her concerns relative to EMFs, the limitations of public studies and public regulatory agencies in regard to 'safe' EMFs, and the conclusions that some individuals and studies have drawn due to exposure to EMFs.

Mr. Mirin noted recent work in the Town of Charlemont, including amendments to their zoning bylaw in relation to placement of small-cell facilities.

Ms. O'Connor asked that the Selectboard support a bill being reviewed at the state level, and stated that a draft letter from State Rep Lindsay Sabadosa relative to the bill would be forwarded to the board for review. The board generally concurred, and would review the draft letter upon receipt.

Mr. Finn noted that a draft letter had already been developed, but that he would review the letter from Rep Sabadosa upon receipt, and amend and modify the draft letter accordingly.

Correspondence

Correspondence was reviewed. No action taken on any item.

Review and approval of AP and Payroll Warrants

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Bronstein

To approve WP26-18 and W26-18

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:04 PM)

Review and approval of minutes of past meetings

The minutes of February 25, 2026, and March 2, 2026 were reviewed. Ms. Milikowsky suggested amendments to the Minutes of February 25, 2026.

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Bronstein

To approve the minutes of February 25 as presented and amended.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (8:09 PM)

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Bronstein

To approve the minutes of March 2 as presented.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (8:11 PM)

MEMBER CONCERNS

Board may discuss new topics raised by individual members, deliberate on potential action or future agenda placement, or give direction to staff.

Ms. Bronstein noted that this week is rural aid advocacy week at the state house and suggested that the town send letters to key parties to get the Town's message out. Milikowsky concurred.

Topic Redress

Ms. Dale Kasal asked some questions in regard to promotion of the Town's website the to assist the town in how to promote the town's website and the website email newsletter.

EXECUTIVE SESSION

The board will enter into executive session to conduct strategy sessions in preparation for negotiations with nonunion personnel or to conduct collective bargaining sessions or contract negotiations with nonunion personnel. Board will exit executive session and immediately adjourn.

It was MOVED by Bronstein SECONDED by Milikowsky

To enter into executive session to conduct strategy sessions in preparation for negotiations with nonunion personnel. The Selectboard will exit executive session and immediately adjourn.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (8:21 PM)

EXECUTIVE SESSION

Adjourn

It was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky
To Adjourn.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (8:50 PM)

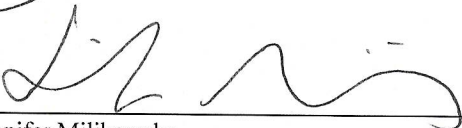
Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on March 23, 2026.



Susan Bronstein



Scott Johndrow



Jennifer Milikowsky